

Stanford University

University IT (UIT)

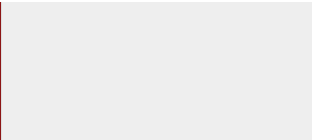
Brand Kit

Based on Stanford University Identity Guide • identity.stanford.edu

01 COLOR PALETTE

Primary colors anchor all Stanford communications. Cardinal Red must always appear somewhere in the color scheme.

PRIMARY COLORS

			
Cardinal Red #8C1515 PMS 201 C	White #EEEEEE Primary	Black #2E2D29 Process Black	Cool Gray #4D4F53 PMS 425 C

PALO ALTO GREEN (LOGO USE)

			
Palo Alto Green #3298C3 PMS 3298 C	Palo Alto #175E54 #175E54	Palo Verde #279989 #279989	Palo Verde Light #59B3A9 #59B3A9

BLACK TINT RAMP (10% INCREMENTS)

90%	80%	70%	60%	50%	40%	30%	20%	10%
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ACCENT COLORS — TEAL / GREEN FAMILY

Palo Alto #175E54	Palo Verde #279989	Palo Verde Lt #59B3A9	Olive #8F993E	Bay #6FA287
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ACCENT COLORS — BLUE / SKY FAMILY

Sky	Sky Light	Sky Dark	Lagunita	Lagunita Lt
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#4298B5	#67AFD2	#016895	#007C92	#009AB4
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ACCENT COLORS — WARM / VIBRANT

Poppy #E98300	Poppy Light #F9A44A	Spirited #E04F39	Illuminating #FEDD5C	Illuminating Lt #FFE781
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ACCENT COLORS — DEEP / NEUTRAL

Plum #620059	Plum Light #734675	Brick #651C32	Stone #7F7776	Fog #DAD7CB
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Note: Accent colors complement the primary palette. They must not become the dominant color for any unit or department.

02 TYPOGRAPHY

Stanford uses Source Sans 3 (open-source) for all digital interfaces and Crimson Text for editorial serif moments.

Display / H1 28px · Bold	University IT Services
Heading 2 20px · SemiBold	IT Security & Compliance
Body text 15px · Regular	Stanford's UIT supports the university's mission through reliable, secure, and innovative technology services.
Serif / Editorial 17px · Italic	<i>“The wind of freedom blows.” — Stanford motto</i>
Caption / Small 13px · Regular	Last updated June 2026 • Stanford University IT • identity.stanford.edu

Primary Fonts
Source Sans 3 (sans-serif)
Crimson Text (serif/editorial)

PC Fallbacks
Calibri (for Source Sans)
Georgia (for Crimson Text)

03 LOGO LOCKUPS & USAGE

The Stanford department logo system allows units to leverage the collective Stanford identity. The lockup pairs the Stanford wordmark with the department name.

APPROVED COLORWAYS



CLEAR SPACE RULE

Always maintain a buffer zone equal to the x-height of the word "Stanford" on all sides. No type or graphics may appear in this zone.

DO'S AND DON'TS

✓ Allowed

- Wordmark in Cardinal Red, white, or black
- Block S with Tree (no counterspace showing)
- Seal for formal and academic use
- Department signature lockup system
- Minimum 85px digital / 0.85in print

✗ Not Allowed

- Vintage / old wordmark versions
- Altering or combining logos
- Promoting third-party organizations
- Taglines in department signatures
- Icons combined with signature logos

04 WEB IDENTITY PATTERNS

All official Stanford websites must include the Identity Bar and Global Footer. These elements provide consistent Stanford branding across the constellation of sites.

IDENTITY BAR (REQUIRED — TOP OF PAGE)

Stanford University

30px tall bar. Cardinal Red (default), White, or Black. Wordmark links to stanford.edu. No other content allowed inside.

GLOBAL FOOTER (REQUIRED — BOTTOM OF PAGE)

Stanford University

[Emergency Info](#) | [Privacy](#) | [Terms](#) | [Copyright](#)

Default Cardinal Red. Stacked Stanford signature links to stanford.edu. No content below the footer.

LOCAL NAVIGATION PATTERN

Local header includes:

- Department logo (links to dept homepage)
- Local search (top right)
- Site main navigation (below logo)

Brand compliance requires:

- Primary color palette for logo and navigation
- Skip navigation link for accessibility
- Source Sans primary typography throughout

05 UI COMPONENTS

BUTTONS

Primary Button Background: #8C1515	Secondary Button Border: #8C1515	Ghost Button Background: #F4F4F4
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STATUS BADGES

Critical	In Progress	Resolved	Scheduled	Closed
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SPACING SCALE

4px	8px	12px	16px	24px	32px	48px	64px
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06 VOICE & TONE

Stanford's voice is optimistic, evidence-led, and humanizing. UIT communications should feel approachable and clear while reflecting the university's spirit of possibility.

✓ Do

- Use clear, direct, jargon-free language
- Write in active voice and positive framing
- Lead with evidence-based, fact-led content
- Use inclusive and accessible tone throughout
- Acknowledge the broader Stanford community
- Reflect the West Coast spirit of possibility

✗ Don't

- Use unexplained technical acronyms
- Make Stanford sound corporate or bureaucratic
- Use vintage or unapproved Stanford wordmarks
- Overpromise or rely on hype language
- Place Cardinal Red on red backgrounds
- Use unauthorized images or photography

07 QUICK REFERENCE

Element	Value	Notes
Cardinal Red	#8C1515 / PMS 201 C	Primary brand color
Palo Alto Green	#3298C3 / PMS 3298 C	Logo use only
Black	#2E2D29 / Process Black	Supporting wordmark
Cool Gray	#4D4F53 / PMS 425 C	Secondary text, UI
Primary font	Source Sans 3	Free / open-source
Serif font	Crimson Text	Editorial use only
PC sans fallback	Calibri	Windows fallback
PC serif fallback	Georgia	Windows fallback
Min logo (digital)	85px wide	Readability minimum
Min logo (print)	0.85 inch wide	Readability minimum
Identity Bar height	30px	Cardinal Red default
Clear space	x-height of Stanford	On all four sides